- Auto-instrumentation is an important baseline method to automatically generate telemetry without changing the application code.
- If a vendor or programming language (in OpenTelemetry) supports auto-instrumentation, use it.
- Where auto-instrumentation doesn't deliver what you need (business logic), you need to manually instrument your code with an OpenTelemetry SDK.
- Use the OpenTelemetry collector to collect and route traces and metrics, and eventually logs, from any source to any destination, forming a universal telemetry agent.
- Agents need to be secure, performant, and lean (minimal resource usage).
- Selecting an agent can take time and may require some effort but is worth the investment in the long run.